

film review **Quiet Detour**

BOW BARRACKS FOREVER

Director: Anjan Dutt
Starring: Victor Banerjee, Lillete Dubey, Moon Moon Sen

The Bow Barracks is a 100-year-old building in north Kolkata. It was once used as a garrison for World War II soldiers but is now home to around 140 Anglo-Indian families. Real estate agents are circling the Barracks like hungry vultures, hoping to buy out the families and replace the heritage building with something shiny and new. Director Anjan Dutt makes the crumbling Barracks a metaphor for the lives of its residents. Like the building, they are



frayed by history and circumstance but yet they endure.

The story-telling is clumsy and often, amateurish. But the uneven screenplay and craft are bolstered by Dutt's overpowering affection and empathy for his flailing, fumbling characters. The standouts here are Victor

Banerjee as Peter the Cheater, a lovable conman and drunk; Lillete Dubey as the resilient but deluded Emily Lobo, and Moon Moon Sen as the fleshy, sad Rosa, desperate for a little love. If you have patience, *Bow Barracks Forever* is a nice, quiet detour from Bollywood. **by Anupama Chopra**

music reviews **Fresh Melodies**

MARIGOLD



Big Music

Shankar-Ehsaan-Loy always come up with surprises. It is for the

first time they are scoring music for a cross-cultural film with great melody and global fusion. Most of the songs in this album are sung by Shaan. *Yeh pyaar kya hai* is a light frothy song with a guitar line with the accompanying instruments playing in the background. The duets are passable. Nikita Nigam sings *Sachha pyaar* in a fresh voice; music directors are bound to use her uniqueness. Shaan tries to imitate Kumar Sanu but falls flat.

recommendations **Mixed Spectrum**

CHENNAI Germany meets Manipur and Bangalore meets America. The Hindu Theatre Festival brings spectacular plays with big names in the fray both from India and from abroad.



The line-up includes *Nine Hills One Valley* from Manipur directed by Ratan Thiyam, *Ristorante Immortale* from Berlin, *To The Death of My Own Family* directed by Peter Rattray from New York, *Checkpoint: Three Strangely Normal Plays* directed by Ruwanthie de Chickera from Colombo and Pegasus Players from Chicago bringing their new play, *My Soul Is a Witness*.

From Mumbai there is *Black With Equal* directed by Vikram Kapadia, *Dear Babu* by Mohan Maharashi and *Butter and Mashed Banana* by Ajay Krishnan from Bangalore. Besides these, there will be a section dedicated to English Theatre Groups from Chennai with plays such as *Welcome to Andromeda*, *The Attempted Assassination of*

Salman Rushdie and *Killing Time*, *Death and the Maiden* and *The Immigrants*.

Students of the Asian College of Journalism under the tutelage of veteran writer and cultural commentator Sadanand Menon will be handing out daily newsletters at the festival. On at the Music Academy and the Sivagami Pethachi Auditorium till August 12.

by Nirmala Ravindran

DELHI Young girls taking to serious dance is a rarity today. Payal Ramchandani, who studied under Kuchipudi dancers Raja and Radha Reddy and is now a disciple of Jairama and Vanashree Rao, will present a Kuchipudi dance recital on August 12 at the India International Centre. This nimble footed girl holds promise.



Sony-BMG
Rs 175

JUNOON

Abhijit Sawant has finally come of age. His voice has matured

for the better. None of the other winners of *Fame Gurukul* have reaped the benefits as Sawant has. To be a successful singer, what is required is a good public relations and music companies to push your talent. Sawant has been lucky with both. For his second solo album, he has not only had a makeover but has even stylised his voice with the help of technology. In this album, five music directors have scored music for 10 songs. The result is an eclectic mix of variety and pleasing sounds. Some of the songs that stand out are *Junoon*, *Tanha* and *Tere bina*. Music director Amit Trivedi is a talent to watch out for.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit